

Changelings

Humans are the creatures most responsible for the Glamour that once saturated the world. On the flip side, they can also be boring, cynical, empty founts of Banality. The human body proved to be the perfect shield against the world crushing down on the Fae. Through powerful magics, the surviving Faeries began incarnating in human bodies. A changeling created this way would live much of her life thinking herself an average human, albeit one with more capacity for dreaming and imagination than normal, until one day she undergoes the Chrysalis and awakens to her faerie nature. Rediscovering her lost soul and her lost heritage, she would seek out other changelings, and discover that the Dreaming wasn't completely gone from the world.

A changeling's true form (her *kith*), whether it be a lusty satyr or a hulking troll, is hidden from the eyes of the mundane. Only other entities of the Dreaming can see her for who she truly is. Gathering among a vaguely feudal society led by the warring noble houses, and divided into Seelie and Unseelie Courts, modern-day changelings struggle to juggle their human life and all the problems that come with their Fae existence. If she embraces her human side too closely, she risks losing herself to Banality, her soul withering and returning to a semblance of the mundane. If she dives too deeply into changeling matters, particularly exploring the parts of the Dreaming still available to her, Bedlam strikes. Her humanity erodes, and she loses touch with both realities, mundane and Dreaming. That's the life of a changeling summed up: It's a narrow road they walk, and far too easy to get lost.

How To Use This Book

Changeling: The Dreaming is a fairly exhaustive work; it covers not only the familiar Kithain that fans of the previous editions of the game know and love, but most of the "secondary" Dreaming-related beings and a whole lot of faerie magic to boot. As such, some guidance in getting around might be useful. This lists the entirety of the book, section by section. Being the huge tome this is, it's divided not just by chapters, but by books, grouping the chapters by what aspect of the game they cover.

Book One – Childling

- **Prelude: Both Sides of the Coin** is a short fiction piece to set the mood of the game.
- **Introduction:** You're reading this right now! This is where you'll learn about the basic concepts of the game, the setting, the characters, and even some media that make for good inspirational material for **Changeling**.
- **Chapter One: A World of Darkness:** The book proper begins with an overview of the World of Darkness, the setting of **Changeling: The Dreaming**, and the specifics that relate to the Fae and their history and society in this world.
- **Chapter Two: Kiths, Seemings, and Houses:** The most basic elements of a changeling can be found here: the story that gives them life, the kind of story they tell, and the noble house

that lords over them (or the noble house that they lord over others, in the case of the sidhe).

- **Chapter Three: Character Creation & Traits:** The rules for creating a character, and the rules that relate directly to how she interacts with the world.

Book Two – Wilder

- **Chapter Four: Arts and Realms:** The first chapter of Book Two lays out the strange Faerie magic that changelings use, cantrips, the dangerous Unleashing techniques, and Nightmare dice.
- **Chapter Five: Rules:** The core mechanics of the Storyteller system are explained in this chapter: dice pools, difficulty ratings, extended actions, multiple actions, and all the other basic systems you need to know.
- **Chapter Six: Systems & Drama:** More advanced rules are covered in this chapter, including combat and **Changeling**-specific rules like Banality and Bedlam.

Book Three – Trump

Chapter Seven: The Dreaming: Chapter Seven is about everything that has to do with the Dreaming that isn't the changelings themselves, from trods to freeholds to the varied types of chimera, not to mention the Dreaming itself as a setting.

Chapter Eight: Storytelling: This chapter provides everything a Storyteller has to know to run **Changeling: The Dreaming**, creating Storyteller characters, compelling settings, and how to run a game that veers between fantasy and tragedy at such breakneck pace.

Chapter Nine: Nightmares and Stranger Things: Not all dreams are pleasant. Included in this chapter are the enemies of the Kithain. Monsters, nightmare creatures, and the Dauntain, broken Changelings twisted into corrupting destroyers.

Appendix 1: The Gallain: Not all changelings descend from European folklore. This chapter is all about kiths and societies that descend from the Dreaming, but don't fit the familiar structure.

Appendix 2: The Enchanted Here you'll find rules for Merits and Flaws, further methods of customizing your **Changeling** characters, and rules for the Kithain's mortal companions, the Kinain and the Enchanted.

Lexicon

Arcadia — The homeland of all Faeries, lost somewhere within the *Dreaming*.

Arts — Methods of shaping *Glamour*, the first half of Faerie magic.

Autumn — The modern age.

Autumn World, the — Mundane reality as experienced by ordinary people. The world of cars and television and nine-to-five jobs, distinct from *the Dreaming*.

Autumn People — Mortals who are so inherently banal that they drag everyone else down with them.